



Culinary Aesthetics and the Ethics of Care Introduction

Theme: Food, Domesticity, and Labor

Focus: How artists use food and hospitality to create connection and meaning.

Vocabulary

Overview

Today's lesson explores how food itself can become art.

We will look at two artists:

- **Rirkrit Tiravanija, *Untitled (Free)* (1992)** — cooking and sharing curry in art galleries.
- **Lee Mingwei, *The Dining Project* (1998)** — intimate dinners with a single guest.

Both artists use the act of eating together as a way to build empathy, care, and community.

Learning Objectives

- Understand how artists use generosity and participation as artistic materials.
 - Discuss how sharing food can carry emotional and ethical meaning.
 - Reflect on how art can repair relationships and build connection.
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Activities

1. Opening Reflection

Read Berger's line: *"The sharing of bread was once a pledge that all would live."*

Write: What does this mean to you? When have you felt connection through food?

2. Study 1 – *Untitled (Free)* by Rirkrit Tiravanija

Look at documentation of the artist cooking curry in the gallery.

Discuss: What makes this art? Is the focus on the food or the people?

3. Study 2 – *The Dining Project* by Lee Mingwei

See photos of the artist dining one-on-one with strangers.

Discuss: How is this different from Tiravanija's work? What emotions or experiences does it create?

4. Group Discussion

- What do these two artists teach us about generosity?
- Can an artwork feed both body and spirit?
- How might Berger's idea of moral eating apply here?

5. Class Reflection

Share one idea: *If art can connect people, what might you create or share?*

Question

How do Tiravanija and Lee Mingwei use food to create connection or repair?

Key Idea

Food can be art when it becomes an act of generosity.

To feed, to share, and to listen are all creative gestures — ways of repairing the world.